

Canon MF4122 and MF4150

Inexpensive units, high running costs

BEST BUY
digit
SEPTEMBER 2007



Canon MF4122

We decided to club these two together because the only thing different about them is that the MF4150 has an ADF, sheet-fed scanner, and fax.

Both MFDs occupy 39 x 43.2 cm—relatively small. Their dashboards feature the same button placement; the MF4150, obviously, also has fax features such as a dialpad and speed-dial buttons to dial stored numbers (up to 100).

Both MFDs are built very well, but as is often the case, the trays seem a little delicate. The input tray has a capacity of 250 sheets; the output tray, 100. There is also a multipurpose tray that holds one sheet of paper—handy for one-off print jobs on media other than what you'd normally keep in the input tray. The ADF of the MF4150 accommodates 35 sheets.

The printer resolution of these MFDs is the lowest 600 x 600 dpi, but as you'll find out, that fact does not affect performance. These can't print as fast as any of the Brother MFDs, but their warm up times are markedly lower. The MF4150 takes 15.7 seconds to warm up, and the MF4122 takes just 7.4. This is the fastest warm-up time we've ever recorded for a laser MFD! The first print takes just under 9 seconds. A combi-document will take the same time to print as a text document. In text as well as graphics, the Canon MFDs print better than any of the other MFDs in this test. The only problem was they could not print white text on black (yes, they printed just a black block). This did not change even when we tried printing at the best quality.



Canon MF4150

The flatbed scanners support A4-size paper, and have an interpolated resolution of 9600 x 9600. The scanners brought up top-notch performance. In the Kodak IT8 card scan test, they were not only able to recognise all 22 shades of grey, but were also able to reproduce all shades of colour better than the other MFDs. The OCR test results were acceptable. These are the fastest scanners of all the ones we've tested, taking just over 6 seconds to scan a monochrome document and less than 40 seconds for an A4-size colour document.

Even in the copying department, these are two of the best! Fine text in the copies was legible, and shades of grey turned out as close to the original as we'd think possible. They were the fastest to print the first copy, taking under 10 seconds.

Canon provides OmniPage SE OCR and Presto! PageManager to handle your OCR needs. The MFDs have a monthly duty cycle of 10,000 prints. Now here's the sore point: while the toner duty cycle is just 2,000 prints—the lowest of all the ones we tested—the cartridge is not inexpensive either, and costs Rs.3,999. This brings the cost per page to an uncomfortably high 2 rupees.

The MF4122 is available for Rs 17,995, while the MF4150 is priced at Rs.25,995. The prices of the units are not too high, but the running costs make it hard to recommend these, even considering their excellent performance.

Brother MFC-7420

A good office all-rounder

BEST BUY
digit
SEPTEMBER 2007



The MFC-7420 is the bigger sibling of the Brother DCP-7010—refer to the *Budget Laser MFDs* section, earlier in this article. Similar in specifications to the DCP-7010, the extra this one features is fax functionality and an ADF tray that holds 35 sheets of paper.

The design, too, is similar to that of the DCP-7010, except that the 7420 has additional buttons for fax, such as the dialpad and eight one-touch dialling buttons. Even the footprint is the same. It is a bit heavier, though, at 9.45 kg. It is built fairly well, except the flaps don't seem too sturdy. The input tray has a capacity of 250, sufficient for most SoHos, while the output tray holds 100 sheets, again not bad.

The scanner happens to be a bit better than that on the DCP-7010 in colour scanning, but is very similar that one in the other aspects. The result of our OCR test was even worse than with the 7010.

The printer and the scanner specs are the same as those of the DCP-7010. Even the printer performance is similar. This unit has a fax memory of 500 pages.

Copying a page took around 21 seconds the first time, but the sustained ppm is around 20 after that. Pretty good, we should say.

This unit features the USB as well as the parallel port interface, and although it does not come with an Ethernet port, it has that option by means of a separately-purchasable Ethernet Print Server. The bundled software comprises the MFL-Pro suite with PaperPort 9.0SE OCR, and also a utility to set up the unit over a network.

The MFC-7420 has a toner duty cycle of 3,500, making for an economical cost per page of 61 paise. Rs 18,000 for this model is justified because of the fax, ADF, and sheet-fed scanner.